

The idea is revolting, but true all the same. Yes, through some crazy means of working of this Universe, people turning green might still, in some way, be harming the environment. The reasons are, it turns out, purely psychological. The human race suffers from a rare chronic condition. We are prone to incessantly patting our backs in the event of having committed the slightest act of virtue/kindness/anything-that-would-supposedly-up-our-karma. Of course, you realize that the 'patting on the backs' was a simile, and might denote anything from a night of unlimited booze, to something much more serious than that. And it is that serious part that concerns us. At our core, we happen to be pretentious procrastinators, who wouldn't stop patting ourselves in the back for that one pinch of goodness that we'd once-upon-a-time come up with. No kidding.



The Earth probably doesn't need our help with that

Studies show that green tekkers are more likely to induce over-consumption among their adopters. You might not take our word for it (though you should), and that is what prompts us to cite examples in this regard.

At the University of California, Berkeley, studies were carried out, and it was concluded that once people got themselves that latest 'efficient' piece of gadgetry, their tendency to use it increased manifold. Further studies show that people, would be more careless in leaving energy-efficient lights on longer. It is just too easy, while thinking that you're doing your bit, isn't it?

Then there are things that you cannot possibly hope to have control over. In economics, it's called the law of 'diminishing marginal utility'. It states that the first glass of water you have will have a huge effect in quenching your thirst. The second will help a little less and so on. By the 10th glass you will be feeling unpleasantly full or even sick. That's the worst aspect: some major environmental policies aren't just ineffective -- they are counterproductive.

Another big reason is the business minded attitude that most people bring to the table here. They expect to see 'returns' on their 'investment' on the green dream. There is just one problem in that mental model - environmental friendliness is a way of life, it is definitely not your friendly neighbourhood hedge fund. Shelton Group, which advocates for sustainable consumer choices, carried out a study showing that of 500 people who had greened their homes, a third saw no reduction in their initial bills. That,